

Jesse Oñate.

BUYER ACTION PLAN · 30 DAYS

JESSE OÑATE · REALTOR®

Your 30-Day Buyer Action Plan.

A SoCal buyer's roadmap. Pre-approval to first offer in four weeks.

● DOWNEY · LA · ORANGE COUNTY

FOUR WEEKS · TWENTY TASKS · ZERO FLUFF

JESSETEK.NET

DRE #02133131

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"The buyer who's lost two offers is the buyer who writes the third one right."
— JESSE OÑATE

Meet Jesse.



THE AGENT

REALTOR® · DRE #02133131 · BILINGUAL

Jesse Oñate.

I'm a Downey-based realtor who's helped 100+ SoCal families buy and sell across LA and Orange County. I work bilingually in English and Spanish.

This plan is the same playbook I walk every first-time buyer through. It's what I wish someone had handed me before I bought my first home.

Jesse Oñate

Realtor® · Downey, CA

Real numbers, real closings.

100+

Families served

Across LA + Orange County since 2022

5.0★

Google rating

100+ verified reviews · zero complaints

EN · ES

Bilingual service

Full transactions in English or Spanish

24h

CMA turnaround

Free, no obligation, real comps

Match your readiness.

From the quiz you just took, start at the right week. Skip ahead if you're ready. Slow it down if you're not.

80+

READY → **Jump to Week 3.**

Foundation is locked. Focus on offer mechanics and DPA.

60–79

STRONG START → **Start at Week 2.**

Fundamentals are there. Tighten market + strategy work.

40–59

BUILDING → **Run the full plan.**

You're at the right pace. Sequencing matters more than speed.

20–39

EARLY → **Use it as 60 days.**

Slow is fine. Rushing pre-approval breaks deals.

<20

EXPLORING → **90-day roadmap.**

Subscribe to the weekly rate text first.

ONE RULE

Finish each week's deliverable before moving on. Skipping ahead is how buyers end up writing offers they can't close.



INTERLUDE

The buyers who win in SoCal aren't the ones with the most money. They're the ones with the most discipline.

JESSE OÑATE

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Foundation.

DAYS 01 – 07

Lock down financing. A real, credit-pulled, income-verified pre-approval is the first thing every seller looks at, and the only thing that turns a lookalike buyer into a real one.

FOUNDATION

01

Lock down financing.

- 01 Get FULLY pre-approved, not pre-qualified. Demand a credit-pulled, income-verified letter from your lender.
- 02 Pull all three credit bureaus yourself at annualcreditreport.com. Dispute any errors within 30 days. Last chance before underwriting locks.
- 03 Audit your debt-to-income. Aim under 43% on the back end. Pay down a card or two if you're over.
- 04 Calculate your max comfortable monthly payment using the 28/36 rule. Comfortable beats max.
- 05 Save your earnest-money cushion: 1–3% of target price, in liquid funds.

INSIDER TIP

"A pre-approval from a small local lender beats the big bank 80% of the time in a multiple-offer scenario. Sellers know who actually closes."

END-OF-WEEK DELIVERABLE

Pre-approval letter in your inbox, signed and dated.



Market.

DAYS 08 – 14

Lock your target areas and must-haves.
The buyers who keep their criteria sheet on
the dashboard close. The ones who rewrite
it every Saturday spend a year not buying.

MARKET

02

Lock your areas.

- 01 Pick three SoCal cities. Cross-reference commute (under 35 min), price ceiling, and schools if relevant.
- 02 Define must-haves. Max 5: yard, garage, bedrooms, walk score. Pick a line and hold it.
- 03 Set up MLS alerts through a realtor. Direct-from-MLS is instant; Zillow lags 24–72 hours.
- 04 Tour 5 homes in person, no pressure. Calibrate the gap between listing photos and reality.
- 05 Walk one closed sale you missed. Drive by, look at what it sold for. Cheap mental rehearsal.

INSIDER TIP

"If your range overlaps a hot tier (Downey under \$750K, Whittier under \$700K), expect 8 to 15 offers per home. Plan for it."

END-OF-WEEK DELIVERABLE

A one-page written criteria sheet your realtor can work from. ☐

Strategy.

DAYS 15 – 21

Be ready to write a winning offer. The mechanics (escalation, appraisal gap, contingencies) are levers. Knowing which to pull is the difference between a winning offer and a fair one.

STRATEGY

03

Write the winning offer.

- 01 Understand SoCal offer mechanics: escalation clauses, appraisal gap coverage, contingency timelines.
- 02 Lock in your down payment program. CalHFA MyHome, Dream For All, Forgivable Equity Builder, Chenoa Fund.
- 03 Pick your realtor. The one who returns calls in under an hour, not the one with the biggest billboard.
- 04 Estimate cash to close: down payment + closing costs (2–3%) + 2 months PITI reserves.
- 05 Get your 'yes I'm ready' letter. Bank statements pulled, gift letters drafted if needed.

INSIDER TIP

"Most CA buyers leave \$5K–\$15K in DPA on the table because their lender never mentions it. Ask. Then ask again."

END-OF-WEEK DELIVERABLE

Cash-to-close worksheet finalized and DPA program confirmed in w

Free money on the table.

Most CA buyers leave \$5K–\$15K in down payment assistance unclaimed because their lender never mentions it. Here are the four programs that actually close.

01 CalHFA MyHome **Up to 3.5% of purchase price**

Forgivable second loan for down payment + closing costs.
Income limits by county.

First-time buyers with under 80% AMI · CalHFA-approved lender required

02 Dream For All **Up to 20% (or \$150K, less)**

Shared-appreciation loan. State takes back the % gained on resale. Highly competitive lottery.

First-gen buyers · primary residence · check open registration windows

03 Forgivable Equity Builder **Up to 10%, fully forgiven**

Forgiven over 5 years if you stay in the home. Truly free money if you don't sell early.

First-time buyers · under 80% AMI · 5-year owner-occupancy required

04 Chenoa Fund **3.5% or 5% of purchase price**

FHA-paired DPA. No income limit on the 5% option. Repayable second mortgage or forgivable.

FHA borrowers · 620+ credit · no first-time-buyer requirement

Execute.

DAYS 22 – 30

First offer in. Your first offer doesn't have to win. It has to teach you the market. The buyer who's lost two offers is the buyer who writes the third one right.

EXECUTE

04

Get the first offer in.

- 01 Tour 5–10 homes that match your criteria sheet. Saturday and Sunday. Bring the sheet.
- 02 Run the comps on your top two picks. Last 90 days, half-mile radius, similar bed/bath/sqft.
- 03 Write your first offer. Strong but disciplined. Don't waive everything.
- 04 Prep for counter-offer scenarios. Decide your walk-away number before you submit.
- 05 If no offer by day 30, identify the single bottleneck (financing, inventory, or criteria) and re-run that week.

INSIDER TIP

"Your first offer doesn't have to win. It has to teach you the market. Patience is a strategy, not a weakness."

END-OF-WEEK DELIVERABLE

At least one offer submitted, with lender's approval letter attached

Free, no email gate, built for SoCal.

-
- 01 Mortgage Calculator** jessetek.net/calculator
Sliders. No email. Real monthly payment, PMI, amortization.

 - 02 Rent vs Buy** jessetek.net/rent-vs-buy
5-year break-even math for your specific city and price.

 - 03 Free Buyer Guide** jessetek.net/guide
The full 5-mistakes guide. Pre-approval, DPA, credit prep.

 - 04 Weekly Rate Texts** jessetek.net/rates
Thursdays 11:30am. 30-second update. No spam.

 - 05 Active Listings** jessetek.net/listings
What I'm working on across LA + Orange County right now.
-

Speak the language.

The twelve terms you'll hear most. Memorize these and you'll never feel out of your depth in a negotiation.

Appraisal Gap	Difference between purchase price and appraised value. You cover it in cash if you waive the appraisal contingency.
Contingency	An escape hatch in your offer (inspection, loan, appraisal). Each one you waive makes your offer stronger and riskier.
DPA	Down Payment Assistance. State/federal programs that loan or grant you down-payment cash. See page 13.
DTI	Debt-to-Income ratio. $\text{Monthly debt} \div \text{monthly gross income}$. Most lenders want under 43%.
Earnest Money	Good-faith deposit when offer accepted (1–3% of price). Goes toward your down payment at closing.
Escalation Clause	"I'll beat the highest offer by \$X up to a cap of \$Y." Use carefully. It shows your ceiling.
HOA	Homeowners Association. Monthly dues for shared amenities/maintenance. Lender counts it in your DTI.
LTV	Loan-to-Value ratio. $\text{Loan amount} \div \text{home value}$. Below 80% LTV = no PMI.
Mello-Roos	A special tax on newer SoCal developments funding local infrastructure. Can add \$100–\$400/mo. Ask before you fall in love.
PITI	Principal, Interest, Taxes, Insurance. Your true monthly housing payment. Plus HOA if applicable.
PMI	Private Mortgage Insurance. Required if you put less than 20% down on a conventional loan. Drops off automatically at 78% LTV.
Pre-Approval	Real, credit-pulled, income-verified loan commitment letter. Beats a pre-qualification 10x in any negotiation.



REAL CLOSING · 2025

This is the part we're working toward.

11 · WHEN YOU'RE READY

Book a free 15-minute strategy call.

No pitch. We pull your numbers, map your timeline, and decide together whether I'm the right realtor for you.

jessetek.net/zoom →

OR REACH OUT DIRECTLY

(562) 609-4200

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SCAN TO BOOK

Opens jessetek.net/zoom

"The best time to plant a tree was 20 years ago. The second best time is now."

— CHINESE PROVERB

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